



APOLLO INSTITUTE OF COMPUTER APPLICATION

BACHELOR OF COMPUTER APPLICATIONS

PREFESSIONAL ETHICS(BC02001081)

ASSIGNMENT 4 / UNIT 4

Short Answer Questions

1. Define a profession.

Ans: A profession is an occupation that requires specialized knowledge, formal education, training, and adherence to a code of ethics. Professionals are expected to provide services with competence, responsibility, and integrity.

2. Explain the evolution of professions.

Ans: The evolution of professions refers to the development of specialized occupations over time as society became more complex. With advancements in knowledge, technology, and education, fields such as medicine, law, engineering, and teaching developed formal training, standards, and ethical guidelines.

3. What is professional ethics?

Ans: Professional ethics are the moral principles and standards that guide the behavior and decisions of professionals in their work. They ensure honesty, responsibility, fairness, and respect while serving clients and society.

4. Why is education important for professional practice?

Ans: Education is important for professional practice because it provides the knowledge, skills, and expertise required to perform professional duties effectively. It also helps professionals understand ethical standards and maintain competence in their field.

5. What is professional licensing?

Ans: Professional licensing is an official authorization given by a regulatory body that allows an individual to practice a profession. It ensures that professionals meet required qualifications, skills, and ethical standards.

6. Explain the concept of ethical decision-making.

Ans: Ethical decision-making is the process of evaluating and choosing actions based on moral principles and professional values. It involves considering the consequences of decisions and ensuring they are fair, responsible, and beneficial to society.

7. What is a code of ethics?

Ans: A code of ethics is a set of guidelines and principles that define acceptable behavior for members of a profession. It helps professionals make ethical decisions and maintain integrity in their work.

8. What is conflict of interest in professional life?

Ans: A conflict of interest occurs when a professional's personal interests interfere with their professional duties or responsibilities. It can affect objectivity and lead to biased decisions.

9. Define professionalism.

Ans: Professionalism refers to the conduct, behavior, and attitude expected from individuals in a professional role. It includes competence, integrity, responsibility, respect, and adherence to ethical standards.

10. List the key characteristics of professional behavior.

Ans: Key characteristics of professional behavior include:

- Integrity and honesty
- Responsibility and accountability

- Competence and expertise
 - Respect for others
 - Commitment to ethical standards.
11. What is accountability in professional practice?
- Ans: Accountability in professional practice means being responsible for one's actions, decisions, and outcomes. Professionals must answer for their work and ensure that their actions meet ethical and professional standards.
12. Explain the importance of public trust in professions.
- Ans: Public trust is important because professionals provide services that affect people's lives and well-being. Ethical behavior and competence help build trust, which ensures confidence in the profession and its services.
13. What are ethical responsibilities of professionals?
- Ans: Ethical responsibilities of professionals include maintaining honesty, protecting confidentiality, ensuring competence, avoiding conflicts of interest, and acting in the best interest of clients and society.
14. Why is continuous learning important for professionals?
- Ans: Continuous learning helps professionals keep up with new developments, technologies, and practices in their field. It ensures they maintain competence and provide high-quality services.
15. What is professional misconduct?
- Ans: Professional misconduct refers to unethical or improper behavior by a professional that violates the standards or code of ethics of the profession. Examples include negligence, dishonesty, or misuse of authority.

Long Answer Questions

1. Explain the evolution of professions and their importance in modern society
- Ans: **Evolution of Professions**
- Early occupations were based on traditional skills and experience.
 - Industrialization and technological development created specialized jobs.
 - Formal education and professional training institutions were established.
 - Professional bodies introduced licensing and certification systems.
 - Codes of ethics were developed to guide professional behavior.
- Importance in Modern Society**
- Provide expert knowledge and specialized services.
 - Help solve complex social and technical problems.
 - Contribute to economic growth and development.
 - Ensure public safety, welfare, and improved quality of life.
2. Discuss the role of education and licensing in maintaining professional standards
- Ans: **Role of Education**
- Provides necessary theoretical knowledge and practical skills.
 - Develops professional competence and expertise.
 - Helps professionals understand ethical principles and responsibilities.
 - Encourages critical thinking and problem-solving abilities.
- Role of Licensing**
- Licensing is official permission to practice a profession.
 - Ensures only qualified individuals provide professional services.
 - Protects the public from unqualified practitioners.
 - Maintains professional standards and accountability.

3. Explain the process of ethical decision-making in professional practice

Ans: Steps involved in ethical decision-making:

- **Identify the ethical problem** or dilemma.
- **Collect relevant information** about the situation.
- **Identify stakeholders** who may be affected by the decision.
- **Evaluate possible alternatives** and their consequences.
- **Consider ethical principles** such as honesty, fairness, and responsibility.
- **Choose the best ethical option** and implement the decision.
- **Review the outcome** and learn from the decision.

4. Discuss professionalism and ethical responsibilities of professionals

Ans: **Professionalism**

- Refers to proper conduct, attitude, and behavior in professional work.
- Includes competence, discipline, responsibility, and respect.

Ethical Responsibilities

- Perform duties honestly and with integrity.
- Maintain confidentiality of client information.
- Avoid conflicts of interest.
- Provide competent and quality services.
- Respect colleagues, clients, and society.
- Follow professional codes of ethics.

5. Explain the importance of a code of ethics in professional life

- Ans:
- A code of ethics provides guidelines for professional behavior.
 - It helps professionals make ethical decisions in difficult situations.
 - Promotes honesty, fairness, and accountability.
 - Prevents professional misconduct and unethical practices.
 - Protects the rights and interests of clients and society.
 - Maintains discipline within the profession.
 - Enhances public trust and professional reputation.

6. Describe the relationship between professional competence and ethics

- Ans:
- Professional competence means having knowledge, skills, and ability to perform tasks effectively.
 - Ethics refers to moral principles guiding professional behavior.
 - Competence ensures professionals can perform their duties correctly.
 - Ethics ensures that professional knowledge is used responsibly.
 - Both are essential for providing reliable and safe services.
 - Lack of competence can cause poor performance.
 - Lack of ethics can lead to misuse of authority and professional misconduct.

7. Discuss ethical dilemmas faced by professionals and ways to resolve them

Ans: **Ethical dilemmas faced by professionals**

- Conflict between personal interest and professional duty.
- Pressure from employers or clients.
- Confidentiality and privacy issues.
- Situations involving honesty and fairness.

Ways to resolve ethical dilemmas

- Identify the ethical issue clearly.
- Refer to professional codes of ethics.

- Evaluate possible alternatives and consequences.
- Seek guidance from colleagues or supervisors.
- Choose the action that protects public interest and ethical standards.

8. Explain how professionalism contributes to public trust and social welfare

- Ans:
- Professionalism ensures responsible and ethical behavior in work.
 - Professionals provide reliable and competent services.
 - Ethical conduct protects the rights and interests of clients.
 - Responsible decisions prevent harm to society.
 - Professionals contribute to development in healthcare, education, and infrastructure.
 - Professional standards ensure fairness and transparency.
 - This builds public trust and promotes social welfare.

9. Discuss the responsibilities of professionals towards society, clients, and employers

Ans: **Responsibilities toward society**

- Ensure public safety and welfare.
- Protect the environment and community interests.

Responsibilities toward clients

- Provide honest and competent services.
- Maintain confidentiality of information.
- Avoid conflicts of interest.

Responsibilities toward employers

- Perform duties responsibly and efficiently.
- Follow organizational policies and rules.
- Maintain loyalty, integrity, and professionalism.

10. Explain the role of ethics in maintaining the integrity of professions

- Ans:
- Ethics provides moral guidelines for professional behavior.
 - Promotes honesty, fairness, and responsibility in work.
 - Prevents corruption, fraud, and misuse of authority.
 - Ensures professionals act in the best interest of society.
 - Maintains discipline through professional codes of ethics.
 - Strengthens credibility and reputation of professions.
 - Builds trust between professionals and the public.